



PATHFINDER KINGMAKER™

With the recent release of *Pathfinder: Wrath of the Righteous*, it made sense to revisit *Pathfinder: Kingmaker*. We hadn't reviewed the game when it first came out, so what better time than now. Crowdfunded and released in 2018, *Pathfinder: Kingmaker* pays homage to the CRPGs of old. If you're familiar with literally any CRPGs from back in the day, we're talking games like *Baldur's Gate*, *Planescape Torment*, *Diablo*, and *Neverwinter Nights*, among others, then you'll feel right at home with *Pathfinder: Kingmaker*. Inspired by the classics, *Kingmaker* has a lot going for it, let's dive in.

STORY

Kingmaker is based on *Pathfinder*, a tabletop RPG that was released back in 2009. *Pathfinder* is largely based on *Dungeons & Dragons 3.5*, and was a result of the introduction of the 4th

O I just can't wait to be king (or queen)

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edition of *Dungeons & Dragons*. There are a lot of new rules, abilities and classes in the game, but at its core, it's still very familiar. You're still rolling a D20 as usual.

Back to the story. As is the norm with RPGs, you start off by creating your character. The gender makes no difference other than potential romances in the game. You're pretty much preparing your character sheet here with your stats, the class you're going to play, what abilities you're going to start out with etc. The game starts off with you and a ragtag group of mercenaries gathered in a

hall. You've been asked to gather in order to conquer a disputed territory called the "Stolen Lands", and the reward for succeeding is a barony of said lands. With you being the protagonist, you do eventually end up as the baron of the stolen lands, and now have your own kingdom to manage as well. While the story starts off fairly simple, it eventually evolves to become quite complicated and filled with political intrigue. There's plenty of plot twists along the way, as you discover what is actually going on in the stolen lands and how everything is being orchestrated from behind the scenes.

The companions in the game are very well written, each with their own distinct personalities and motivations. They've each got their own alignments and views that could lineup or clash with your own. Clash with them too often, and they'll confront you about it or leave your party. You pick